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VITMUN'26[🐦]

WHERE YOUR VOICE MATTERS



AGENDA

Countering the use of information and communications technologies for criminal purposes.
Meeting Dated - 11th November 2024

BACKGROUND GUIDE | UNGA SOCHUM



Letter from the Executive Board

Dear Delegates,

We welcome you to VITMUN 2026's United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) – Social, Humanitarian and Cultural Committee (SOCHUM). The agenda which we picked is “Countering the use of information and communications technologies for criminal purposes” (Agenda Item 108). To be more specific, we will be simulating the meeting of the SOCHUM on the 11th November 2024.

As you may have noticed, the agenda is historic. Most of the records of statements made by countries and the events that transpired are available online. Therefore, if you opened this document in the hopes of finding a traditional background guide, we apologise for betraying your expectations.

In our opinion, the main topic of discourse should ideally be the [Report of the Ad Hoc Committee dated 19th August 2024](#) which was [transmitted to the SOCHUM](#) for consideration. Please note that apart from the Draft United Nations Convention against Cybercrime, the Report also carries a proposed Draft Resolution to be passed by the UNGA.

With that said, we wish to convey the following information regarding this simulation:

1. We will not be running the standard UNA-USA rules of procedure. The rules of procedure will be determined by the Executive Board on Day 1.
2. You can use the internet during committee sessions. However, the Internet may not be provided to you by the University. Please note that if you are unprepared, the internet is probably not going to help you.
3. We will not be maintaining a Marking Sheet – However, if a majority of you desperately need arbitrary numbers for quantifying your performance (to be determined by vote), we shall provide you with the same.
4. We may be running Committee in a manner where Amendments to the existing Draft Convention will be accepted and voted on. While this may be unconventional, this is purely for the purpose of the competition. **Please note that the act of sending in an Amendment will not be considered a violation of foreign policy.** The contents of your Amendment and your motivation behind the Amendment on the other hand, need to be aligned with your foreign policy / interests. The procedure for Amendments is yet to be determined.



So how do you best prepare for this Committee?

1. Read about the Agenda from a neutral standpoint. Go through the **Reports and other relevant documents of all sessions of the Ad Hoc Committee**. While doing so, you will be able to gain an understanding of the position of most countries with respect to the Draft Convention. Treat the MUN as though it is going to be an exam on the Convention on Cybercrime.
2. Go through the various statements issued by Countries (in their respective websites) on the Draft Convention.
3. Ideally, after a comprehensive study, pick an allotment with a game plan. If you don't get a favourable allotment, it is not the end of the world.
4. Ask yourself if the Convention can be improved? If yes, how? Can my country propose such an Amendment? Has your country already proposed any Amendments? **(Note : Based on EB discretion, we may entertain Amendments which already failed in the Ad Hoc Committee).**

Finally, we wish to reiterate that our duty as members of the Executive Board is only to moderate committee, and there will be no substantial intervention from our side unless the same is warranted. We hope you leave this event with a greater understanding of the United Nations, diplomacy, and geopolitics.

If you have any questions, please save them for Day 1 of the conference.

We look forward to meeting all of you!

Best,

Sashank Srinivas - Co-Chairperson

Siddharth Bandam - Co-Chairperson

Parnika Prakash - Director